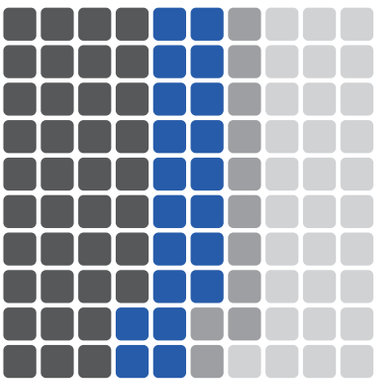
One in five adults in Ethiopia's Findex survey carries a phone but has no account.

Most of those phones can't run an app.
This page shows who they are and why they say they have no account.

Of every 100 adults surveyed



38
have a phone and an account

20
have a phone but no account

11
have an account but no phone

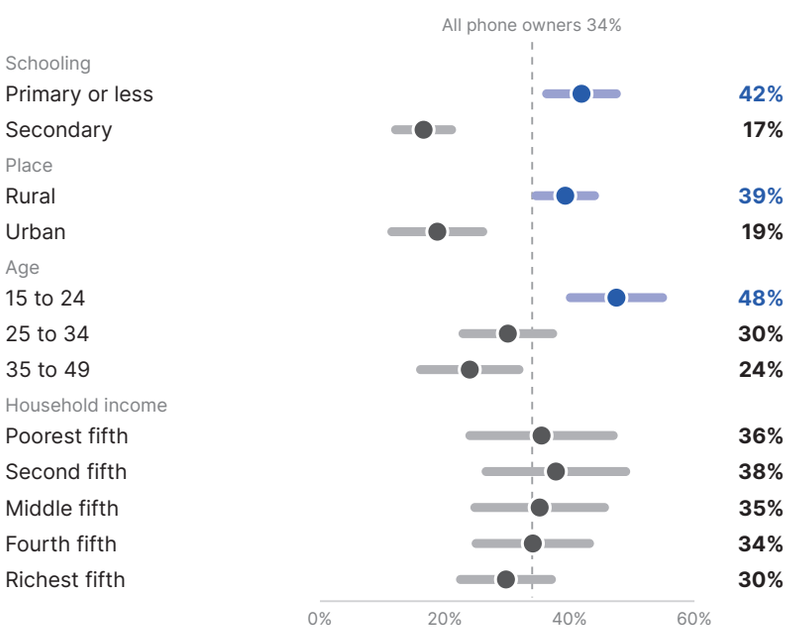
31
have neither

84%
of those 20 carry a basic phone, not a smartphone
against 65% of phone owners with an account

13%
of those 20 used the internet in the past three months

The gap follows schooling, place and age. Income shows no clear pattern.

Share of phone owners with no account. Lines show 95% intervals.



Most say they don't have enough money

Phone owners with no account (n = 192). More than one reason allowed.

For 37%, money was the only reason.

What to test next

Basic-phone onboarding
84% carry basic phones and few go online. A small pilot of USSD menus and agent-assisted sign-up would show whether they work.

The "not enough money" reason
Interviews would show whether it means fees, minimum balances, or a belief that accounts aren't for small amounts.

Who to reach
Schooling, place and age separate this group more clearly than income. Provider sign-up data by area would test that.

Sources and caveats

Source: World Bank, Global Findex Database 2025, individual microdata (doi.org/10.48529/bk9n-8r43). 1,001 adults aged 15+, interviewed face to face, 15 Oct to 29 Nov 2024. All figures weighted.

Coverage: the survey excluded Amhara, Tigray, Somali and Harari, about 30% of the population. Figures describe the surveyed areas, not all of Ethiopia.

Small sample: the phone-but-no-account group is 192 people. Intervals are approximate and a lower bound on uncertainty. Groups under 60 respondents (tertiary schooling, ages 50+) are not shown.

Read as patterns, not causes. Reasons are self-reported.

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